

DET at CAR · Sunday 2026-10-04 20:20 ET · Week 4 2026

League-wide only. Window: weeks 4–9, 2015–2025.  $n \geq 10$ . No team streaks. No half-EPA. Lines from nflverse games.csv (snapshot Oct 1). Scores and team-week stats through Week 3; EPA from play-by-play.

Line: DET -3.5 / CAR +3.5, total 50.5. Trip: DET → CAR 501 mi, 0 time zones. Rest: DET 7 days, CAR 7 days. Roof: outdoors.

1. Season boxes

| Wk | Team | Spot     | Score | Line | ATS   | Off yds | Rush | Pass EPA | Off EPA | Def EPA allowed | SR   | TO |
|----|------|----------|-------|------|-------|---------|------|----------|---------|-----------------|------|----|
| 1  | DET  | H vs NO  | 31–30 | –7.0 | miss  | 371     | 165  | +5.9     | -2.1    | +1.7            | 0.45 | 1  |
| 2  | DET  | A at BUF | 31–41 | +5.5 | miss  | 393     | 66   | +18.6    | +18.3   | +31.2           | 0.49 | 0  |
| 3  | DET  | H vs NYJ | 31–24 | –7.0 | push  | 400     | 131  | +12.1    | +12.6   | +7.1            | 0.60 | 0  |
| 1  | CAR  | H vs CHI | 37–59 | +3.0 | miss  | 486     | 125  | +15.1    | +8.8    | +27.0           | 0.47 | 3  |
| 2  | CAR  | A at ATL | 34–3  | –2.5 | cover | 355     | 68   | +11.1    | +2.3    | -33.5           | 0.40 | 0  |
| 3  | CAR  | A at CLE | 18–21 | –2.5 | miss  | 389     | 98   | -5.9     | -7.7    | +0.2            | 0.37 | 1  |

Last game EPA (PBP): DET off +12.6, def allowed +7.1, net +5.5, SR 0.60. CAR off -7.7, def allowed +0.2, net -7.9, SR 0.37. Records: DET 2–1, CAR 1–2. ATS: DET 0–2, CAR 1–2.

2. Lookahead and rest

- DET: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, home, won by 7). 7 days rest. Week 5: road vs ARI, non-division, Sunday late window.
- CAR: last played week 3 (Sunday early window, road, lost by 3). 7 days rest. Week 5: bye.

3. Sides — CAR +3.5

CAR (home dog)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

| Cut                           | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|-------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| home dog                      | 168–169–8 | 49.9% | 345 |
| Sunday night home dog         | 10–8–1    | 55.6% | 19  |
| home dog +3.5 to +6.5         | 48–57     | 45.7% | 105 |
| Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5 | 10–11     | 47.6% | 21  |

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

| Cut                                                   | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| off EPA ≤ -1 last, home dog                           | 105–77–7  | 57.7% | 189 |
| off a loss as favorite, home dog +3.5 to +6.5         | 5–11      | 31.2% | 16  |
| off a loss as favorite, home dog                      | 16–25–1   | 39.0% | 42  |
| equal rest, home dog +3.5 to +6.5                     | 28–38     | 42.4% | 66  |
| scored ≤21 last, home dog                             | 109–92–7  | 54.2% | 208 |
| off an ATS miss, home dog +3.5 to +6.5                | 22–30     | 42.3% | 52  |
| next game is road, home dog +3.5 to +6.5              | 34–43     | 44.2% | 77  |
| allowed ≤21 last, home dog                            | 65–54–5   | 54.6% | 124 |
| allowed ≤21 last, Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5       | 4–7       | 36.4% | 11  |
| next game is road non-division, home dog +3.5 to +6.5 | 27–34     | 44.3% | 61  |
| off an ATS miss, Sunday night                         | 34–27–4   | 55.7% | 65  |
| bye next week, Sunday night                           | 13–9–1    | 59.1% | 23  |
| allowed ≤21 last, Sunday night                        | 31–38     | 44.9% | 69  |
| off a road game, home dog +3.5 to +6.5                | 32–39     | 45.1% | 71  |
| bye next week, home dog                               | 23–18     | 56.1% | 41  |
| success rate ≤ .40 last, home dog                     | 71–62–3   | 53.4% | 136 |
| equal rest, home dog                                  | 111–100–5 | 52.6% | 216 |
| off a road game, Sunday night                         | 38–32–4   | 54.3% | 74  |

| Cut                                          | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| next game is road, home dog                  | 126–115–7 | 52.3% | 248 |
| success rate $\leq .40$ last, Sunday night   | 16–20–3   | 44.4% | 39  |
| opponent off a win, home dog                 | 105–96–4  | 52.2% | 205 |
| outdoors, Sunday night home dog              | 6–4–1     | 60.0% | 11  |
| bye next week, home dog +3.5 to +6.5         | 6–4       | 60.0% | 10  |
| off a loss, Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5    | 4–6       | 40.0% | 10  |
| off a loss, home dog +3.5 to +6.5            | 30–35     | 46.2% | 65  |
| off EPA $\leq -1$ last, Sunday night         | 20–24–3   | 45.5% | 47  |
| next game is road, Sunday night              | 32–37–3   | 46.4% | 72  |
| off a loss, opponent off a win, Sunday night | 16–13–2   | 55.2% | 31  |

#### 4. Sides — DET –3.5

Mirror of the chair above. Same games, other side.

##### DET (road favorite)

Spot anchors (nested — the same games appear in more than one row; identical populations are collapsed below):

| Cut                           | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|-------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| road favorite                 | 169–168–8 | 50.1% | 345 |
| Sunday night road favorite    | 8–10–1    | 44.4% | 19  |
| road fav –3.5 to –6.5         | 57–48     | 54.3% | 105 |
| Sunday night fav –3.5 to –6.5 | 11–10     | 52.4% | 21  |

Conditionals on those anchors, ranked by distance from 50% scaled by n:

| Cut                                                   | ATS       | Pct   | n   |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-------|-----|
| road team from dome, outdoors, road favorite          | 46–30–1   | 60.5% | 77  |
| 0 turnovers last, Sunday night                        | 29–17–2   | 63.0% | 48  |
| next game is road, road fav –3.5 to –6.5              | 22–12     | 64.7% | 34  |
| scored $\geq 30$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5          | 24–14     | 63.2% | 38  |
| off a home game, road fav –3.5 to –6.5                | 41–28     | 59.4% | 69  |
| next game is road non-division, road fav –3.5 to –6.5 | 15–8      | 65.2% | 23  |
| success rate $\geq .50$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5   | 13–7      | 65.0% | 20  |
| off a 1-score win, Sunday night                       | 22–14–2   | 61.1% | 38  |
| off a 1-score win, road fav –3.5 to –6.5              | 19–12     | 61.3% | 31  |
| equal rest, road fav –3.5 to –6.5                     | 38–28     | 57.6% | 66  |
| scored 27–33 last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5              | 15–9      | 62.5% | 24  |
| scored $\geq 30$ last, Sunday night                   | 19–27–1   | 41.3% | 47  |
| 0 turnovers last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5               | 17–11     | 60.7% | 28  |
| opponent off an ATS miss, road fav –3.5 to –6.5       | 30–22     | 57.7% | 52  |
| off EPA $\geq +8$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5         | 26–19     | 57.8% | 45  |
| 0 turnovers last, road favorite                       | 45–54–1   | 45.5% | 100 |
| opponent off an ATS miss, Sunday night                | 27–34–4   | 44.3% | 65  |
| off a win as favorite, Sunday night                   | 26–32–2   | 44.8% | 60  |
| equal rest, road favorite                             | 100–111–5 | 47.4% | 216 |
| TO $\leq 1$ last, road fav –3.5 to –6.5               | 36–30     | 54.5% | 66  |
| next game is road non-division, road favorite         | 39–33–1   | 54.2% | 73  |
| off a home game, road favorite                        | 117–107–5 | 52.2% | 229 |
| off a win, road favorite                              | 96–105–4  | 47.8% | 205 |
| opponent off a loss, Sunday night fav –3.5 to –6.5    | 6–4       | 60.0% | 10  |
| outdoors, Sunday night road favorite                  | 4–6–1     | 40.0% | 11  |

| Cut                                                | ATS     | Pct   | n  |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------|-------|----|
| off EPA $\geq$ +8 last, Sunday night road favorite | 4–6     | 40.0% | 10 |
| off a home game, Sunday night                      | 29–34–2 | 46.0% | 65 |
| opponent off a loss, road fav –3.5 to –6.5         | 35–30   | 53.8% | 65 |

## 5. Total 50.5

| Cut                                     | Over–Under | Over pct | n   |
|-----------------------------------------|------------|----------|-----|
| Sunday night, outdoors, total $\geq$ 50 | 2–12       | 14.3%    | 14  |
| Sunday night, total $\geq$ 50           | 4–15       | 21.1%    | 19  |
| Sunday night, total $\geq$ 47           | 10–24      | 29.4%    | 34  |
| Sunday night, outdoors, total $\geq$ 47 | 6–17       | 26.1%    | 23  |
| outdoors, total $\geq$ 50               | 37–57–2    | 39.4%    | 96  |
| Sunday night                            | 26–43–1    | 37.7%    | 70  |
| outdoors, home dog, total $\geq$ 50     | 12–24      | 33.3%    | 36  |
| Sunday night, outdoors                  | 19–32–1    | 37.3%    | 52  |
| home dog, total $\geq$ 50               | 23–33–2    | 41.1%    | 58  |
| Sunday night, home dog                  | 12–7       | 63.2%    | 19  |
| outdoors, home dog                      | 122–138–2  | 46.9%    | 262 |
| outdoors, total $\geq$ 47               | 109–124–3  | 46.8%    | 236 |
| total $\geq$ 50                         | 71–82–4    | 46.4%    | 157 |
| total $\geq$ 47                         | 167–179–5  | 48.3%    | 351 |
| outdoors, home dog, total $\geq$ 47     | 42–46      | 47.7%    | 88  |
| home dog                                | 167–174–4  | 49.0%    | 345 |
| outdoors                                | 343–350–7  | 49.5%    | 700 |
| home dog, total $\geq$ 47               | 61–63–2    | 49.2%    | 126 |

## 6. What does not apply

- 2+ time-zone trip: no
- double-digit dog: no
- off a 10-point loss: no
- off a 20-point win: no
- 2nd straight home game: no
- 2nd straight road game: no
- bye next week: applies to CAR
- off a bye: no
- scored  $\leq$ 10 last: no
- short week: no
- trip  $\geq$ 1000 mi: no
- TO  $\geq$ 3 last: no
- undefeated entering: no
- winless entering: no

## 7. Stack, without double-counting

Stack floor is  $n \geq 20$  (tables use  $n \geq 10$ ) so the conjunction cannot bottom out on the cutoff. Under each stack: by-season W-L, cover-margin quartiles with signed tails, parent-minus-child (the stack without each trait, and the games that trait removed), the anchor's complement, and the stack split by line bucket.

- **CAR +3.5** — one population: Sunday night dog +3.5 to +6.5. ATS 10–11 (47.6%,  $n=21$ ). Not added ( $n$  would fall under 20, or the trait does not narrow the population): off a loss, off a 1-score loss, off an ATS miss, off a loss as favorite, off a road game, next game is road, next game is road non-division, bye next week....
- By season: 16:0-1 17:0-1 18:3-3 19:1-1 20:2-0 21:4-0 22:0-1 23:0-1 24:0-3
- Cover margin: median -0.5,  $q_{25}/q_{75}$  -2.5/+5.5;  $P(>+7)$  0.14,  $P(<-7)$  0.19

- Anchor alone 10–11 (47.6%, n=21); anchor minus stack 0–0 (—, n=0)
- Stack by line bucket: +3.5 to +6.5 10–11 (47.6%, n=21)
- **DET -3.5** — one population: Sunday night fav -3.5 to -6.5. ATS 11–10 (52.4%, n=21). Not added (n would fall under 20, or the trait does not narrow the population): off a win, off a 1-score win, off a win as favorite, off a home game, trip 200–1000 mi, 0 time zones, next game is road, next game is road non-division....
- By season: 16:1-0 17:1-0 18:3-3 19:1-1 20:0-2 21:0-4 22:1-0 23:1-0 24:3-0
- Cover margin: median +0.5, q25/q75 -5.5/+2.5; P(>+7) 0.19, P(<-7) 0.14
- Anchor alone 11–10 (52.4%, n=21); anchor minus stack 0–0 (—, n=0)
- Stack by line bucket: -3.5 to -6.5 11–10 (52.4%, n=21)

Feeds: nflverse games.csv (lines, scores, rest), stats\_team\_week 2015–2026 (yards, pass EPA, TO), play\_by\_play 2015–2026 (off/def EPA, success rate), data/airports.csv (miles, zones).